MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 1, Episode 5

"Housewarming"

Episode 1x05. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 1x05. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Friday, August 5, 2005, 5:08 AM through Saturday, August 6, 2005, 1:05 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 41 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-1x04

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on July 1, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Friday, August 5, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	25
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (12 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	27
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband; step coach	Apr 3, 1975	30
Imani Batts (new)	Patient: HCM cardiac arrest	Mar 30, 1989	16
Lt. Tanisha 'Tee' Rollins	FDNY EMS	Aug 16, 1976	28
Andre Fontaine	FDNY Paramedic	Feb 25, 1978	27
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Evangeline Truitt (new)	Patient; QGH board member	Dec 1, 1934	70
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25
Cheryl Batts (new)	Imani's mother; NYPD Transit	Jun 1, 1964	41
Dr. Marlene Fisk (new)	Director, Employee Health	Oct 3, 1947	57
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Hattie 'Miss Hattie' Lomax	Head Cook	Mar 3, 1945	60
Lillian Divine	Harmony's mother	Feb 14, 1952	53
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Officer Delroy Mathis (new)	NYPD 108th Precinct	May 14, 1967	38
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	42
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Dr. Abraham Lowery (new)	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	58
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52

Also appearing: step team members, an EMT, a nurse, about 60 party guests (nurses, residents and interns), and a resident DJ. Clayton Hartwell is on the phone, unheard.

Black don't crack (C-018): every regular reads several years younger than their age on screen. The ages above are exact and binding.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 5:08 AM

Pre-dawn. The kitchen table is buried under a stack of neon-orange flyers hot off a Kinko's printer. RAVEN (25) admires one. MARC (26) reads it over her shoulder, eating cereal. HARMONY (26) stands at the sink in her scrubs, scratching the palm of one hand absently.

> INSERT: THE FLYER. "YOU'RE INVITED!!! HOUSEWARMING @ THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVE. FRIDAY 8/5, 9 PM TIL ??? BRING A DISH, BRING A FRIEND, BRING YOUR DANCING SHOES. NO SCRUBS ALLOWED. HOSTED BY RAVEN, HARMONY & (TECHNICALLY) MARC."

MARC
"Technically" Marc?

RAVEN
It's your house. We're the vision.

MARC
How many people did you invite?

RAVEN
(vaguely)
Some.

MARC
Raven.

RAVEN
I put forty flyers in the cafeteria. Sixty in the locker rooms. Miss Hattie said she'd bring her potato salad, and that's basically a royal decree.

MARC (V.O.)
They say you can tell everything about a person by the way they throw a party.

MARC (V.O.)
Who they invite. Who they leave out. And who shows up uninvited.

Harmony keeps scratching her palm. Marc notices.

MARC
What's wrong with your hand?

HARMONY
(hiding it behind her back)
Nothing. It's a rash. It's the new hand soap. Everybody's breaking out.

MARC
Let me see.

HARMONY
(backing toward the door)
It's soap, Marc. Not everything is a case.

She leaves for work. Marc and Raven exchange a look.

2 INT. OLD MAIN - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 5:51 AM

The locker room. Taped to the inside of the door, where everyone has to see it, is an official memo on Queens Grace letterhead. A crowd of interns reads it in silence.

INSERT: THE MEMO. "QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMPLOYEE HEALTH. CONFIDENTIAL EXPOSURE NOTICE. Date: August 4, 2005. Several employees have recently been diagnosed with infectious syphilis. Any staff member who may have been exposed, or who has noticed a painless sore, a rash (including on the palms or soles), fever or swollen glands, is strongly encouraged to come to Employee Health for confidential, free testing and treatment. All results are protected by New York State law. -- Dr. Marlene Fisk, Director, Employee Health."

AMOND
(reading, flat)
Syphilis. In 2005. We're a hospital, not a Civil War field camp.

ARIANNA
(reading over his shoulder, very still)
It says "several."

AMOND
"Several" is a word administrators use when they mean "a number we don't want to say out loud."

Arianna steps back from the memo. Her face does nothing. That's the tell.

Esther (25) comes in, reads the memo, and raises her eyebrows.

ESTHER
Painless sore, rash on the palms and soles. Secondary syphilis. Classic presentation. (beat) Somebody's been busy.

In the back of the room, Harmony stands frozen at her locker, staring at her own palm. Faint, copper-colored spots.

3 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - THE BOARD - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 6:08 AM

Elxa (27), twelve weeks pregnant, sleeves rolled up, at the Board. A neon-orange party flyer is stuck to the corner of the Board with tape.

ELXA
Who put a party flyer on my Board?

RAVEN
(raising her hand)
You're invited!

ELXA
I'm twelve weeks pregnant and I'm on my feet fourteen hours a day. I'm not invited to anything. I'm invited to my couch.

MARC
There's going to be a couch at the party.

ELXA
(beat, deadpan)
Is it a good couch?

MARC
It's a fantastic couch. It's a Donohue... (catching himself) ...a doozy. It's a doozy of a couch.

Amond's head turns, just slightly. He heard the stumble. He files it away.

ELXA
(assigning)
Bullock, Baker: the Pit. Smilley, Ellison: VIP on the 9th floor, Mrs. Evangeline Truitt, a board member, inguinal hernia repair this morning, and she wants to be treated like a queen. Divine, you're with me. Cummings, Boykin wants you back, and frankly so does everyone else.

ARIANNA
(instead of a comeback)
Actually, I need an hour. Employee Health.

A small beat in the room. Nobody says anything. Elxa looks at her.

ELXA
(evenly)
Take an hour.

4 EXT. JAMAICA HIGH SCHOOL - ATHLETIC FIELD - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 6:33 AM

An August morning already turning hot. A summer step-team practice on the blacktop: a dozen TEENAGE GIRLS in matching gray T-shirts, stomping and clapping in sharp rhythm. RUSSELL JEFFRIES (30), Elxa's husband, in a whistle and a QUEENS STEPS UP T-shirt, claps out the count.

RUSSELL
Five, six, seven, eight! Sharper! Sharper, ladies! This is a competition routine, not a cookout!

At the front, the captain, IMANI BATTS (16), tall and fierce, nails every hit. Her stomps crack like gunshots. She spins and grins at her teammates.

IMANI
Again! From the top!

They launch back in. Thirty seconds into the routine, Imani misses a beat. Then another. She sways. Her hand goes to her chest.

IMANI
(puzzled)
Coach, I feel...

She drops. Not a faint. A collapse. Straight to the blacktop, without putting out her hands.

The girls scream. Russell sprints to her. She's not breathing. Her eyes are open and fixed.

RUSSELL
(shouting, kneeling)
Somebody call 911! NOW! Get the AED from the gym door! GO!

He starts chest compressions, hard and fast, counting out loud, the way the summer CPR course taught him two months ago.

RUSSELL
One, two, three, four... come on, Imani... come on, baby girl...

SMASH TO:

MAIN TITLE: MERCY'S ANATOMY

ACT ONE

5 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 7:02 AM

The doors bang open. Lt. Tee Rollins and Andre Fontaine wheel in Imani on a stretcher, an EMT doing compressions. Russell runs alongside in his whistle, pale and sweating. Marc and Amond are waiting with Dr. Robert Bullock (49).

TEE
Sixteen-year-old female, collapsed at step practice. Witnessed arrest. Coach started CPR right away. The school AED shocked her once at the scene, and she got a pulse back. She lost it again in the rig. We shocked her a second time. She's got a pulse now. Rhythm's been back and forth.

ROBERT
Monitor. Now.

Imani's on the trauma table. The monitor shows a fast, irregular rhythm.

AMOND
V-tach. She's going to lose her pressure.

ROBERT
Pads on. One-twenty biphasic. Charge.

Marc slaps on the pads. The defibrillator whines.

ROBERT
Clear.

THUMP. Imani's body jerks. The monitor flatlines for a terrifying second... then sinus rhythm returns. Regular. Strong.

AMOND
Sinus. Pressure one-oh-two over sixty.

Russell, in the doorway, grabs the frame with both hands.

ROBERT
(to Russell)
You're the one who did CPR?

RUSSELL
I'm her coach. I took a course in June. I... I teach chemistry.

ROBERT
(evenly)
You kept her brain alive, Coach. Without you, there'd be nothing for us to save.

Marc glances at Russell. Their eyes meet: brothers-in-law, both pretending they're just a coach and an intern.

MARC
(gently)
Mr. Jeffries. Let's get you some water.

6 INT. PELL PAVILION - 9TH FLOOR - VIP SUITE - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 7:21 AM

A VIP suite with a view of the Manhattan skyline. MRS. EVANGELINE TRUITT (70), regal, wearing a silk turban and pearls in her hospital bed, an heiress who has sat on the QGH board for twenty-two years. She's reading the Wall Street Journal. Esther and Raven stand at attention.

MRS. TRUITT
Two interns. For a hernia. Natasha must think very highly of me.

RAVEN
We're very excited to be here, Mrs. Truitt.

MRS. TRUITT
(not looking up)
Nobody is excited to be anywhere at seven in the morning, darling. Coffee. Not hospital coffee. There's a Starbucks on Jackson Avenue. A grande. Two Splendas. Whole milk.

ESTHER
Mrs. Truitt, you're NPO for surgery. Nothing by mouth.

MRS. TRUITT
(finally looking up)
I didn't say I'd drink it. I said I'd like to smell it. I've been married three times, and I've outlived all three. I'm allowed to smell coffee.

Raven looks at Esther. Esther looks at Raven.

RAVEN
(cheerfully)
I'll get you a coffee to smell.

MRS. TRUITT
(beat, pleased)
I like you. You're from the South.

RAVEN
Savannah.

MRS. TRUITT
I'm from Charleston. Before I married money. Twice. (beat) Is that Smilley girl the one from the posters?

Esther stiffens.

MRS. TRUITT
(waving it off)
Oh, sit down, darling. I was a showgirl at the Apollo in 1953. I've been in less. (beat) You looked marvelous.

7 INT. STARBUCKS - JACKSON AVENUE - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 7:36 AM

A crowded morning Starbucks: commuters, construction workers from the new towers, a guy in a Mets jersey. Raven, in scrubs and a white coat, waits at the counter for a grande with two Splendas and whole milk that nobody will drink. Behind her in line: Monty Gaines (42), in a crisp linen shirt.

MONTY
Doc. From across the street.

RAVEN
(brightening)
You're the bar! Monty's on Jackson!

MONTY
I'm the bar.

RAVEN
(pulling a flyer from her coat pocket)
We're having a housewarming tonight. 49th Avenue. You should come. Bring a dish.

MONTY
(reading)
"Hosted by Raven, Harmony and, technically, Marc." (chuckling) The tall one. The house with seven bedrooms.

RAVEN
You know Marc?

MONTY
Everybody on Jackson Avenue knows Marc. He tips like a man who doesn't know what money is. (beat, casually) He and the elegant one closed my bar down the night before y'all started. June thirtieth. Left together.

Raven's mouth falls open.

RAVEN
The elegant one. Esther?

MONTY
(realizing he's said too much, smoothly)
I'm a bartender, Doc. I don't remember anything. I'll bring ice. And the good speakers.

The BARISTA calls out "Grande, two Splenda, whole!" Raven grabs it, still stunned.

RAVEN
(to herself, on her way out)
The night BEFORE?

8 INT. PELL PAVILION - EMPLOYEE HEALTH CLINIC - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 7:44 AM

A small clinic tucked behind the employee cafeteria. A waiting room with six chairs. Every chair is taken by staff in scrubs, avoiding eye contact. Arianna sits in the corner chair, arms crossed, chewing her gum furiously.

The door opens. Harmony walks in, sees the full waiting room and Arianna, and freezes.

HARMONY
(backing up)
I'll come back.

ARIANNA
(not looking at her)
Sit down, Double-O. We're all here for the same thing.

Harmony sits in the one free chair, right next to Arianna. Silence.

HARMONY
(whispering)
I have a rash on my palms.

ARIANNA
(whispering)
I know. I saw you scratching in the locker room.

HARMONY
(horrified)
Who else saw?

ARIANNA
Everybody who's ever taken a microbiology exam.

Harmony puts her face in her hands.

HARMONY
(muffled)
I've only been with one person in two years. ONE. One time. After the bridge. I was so happy we saved people that I... (beat) Oh, God. My mother is going to find out. My mother finds out EVERYTHING.

ARIANNA
(beat, curious despite herself)
Who was it?

HARMONY
(beat, miserable)
I'm not telling you that.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Fair.

The door opens. KENDRA WALLACE (25) comes out of an exam room. She sees Arianna. Arianna sees her. Kendra's face goes very still. She walks past without stopping.

NURSE (O.S.)
Cummings?

9 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - BED 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 8:15 AM

Imani, intubated, on a cooling blanket. Monitors, lines. Her mother, CHERYL BATTS (41), a transit cop in her NYPD Transit Bureau uniform, sits by the bed, rigid with shock. Amond reads an echocardiogram on a laptop. Robert stands beside him.

AMOND
Interventricular septum is thirty-one millimeters thick. Normal is under twelve. There's systolic anterior motion of the mitral valve. Outflow tract obstruction.

ROBERT
Say it.

AMOND
Hypertrophic cardiomyopathy. The heart muscle is so thick it blocks its own outflow. And it causes arrhythmias. Sudden death in young athletes.

CHERYL
(barely audible)
She's an athlete. She's been stepping since she was nine. She runs track. She's never been sick a day in her life.

ROBERT
Mrs. Batts, with HCM, many people don't have symptoms until the first event. Sometimes the first symptom is the arrest. (beat) Your daughter is alive because her coach started CPR within seconds and the school had an AED on the gym door.

CHERYL
(gripping Imani's hand)
Will she wake up?

ROBERT
We're cooling her body to protect her brain. We'll know more in twenty-four to forty-eight hours. If she wakes up well, she'll need a defibrillator implanted in her chest. And she'll need to make changes.

CHERYL
What changes?

Robert hesitates. Amond answers before he can.

AMOND
(quietly)
Competitive stepping. Track. High-intensity sports. With HCM like this, they're... the guidelines say no.

Cheryl looks at her unconscious daughter, at the step-team T-shirt the EMTs cut off her, folded on the chair.

CHERYL
(whispering)
That's her whole life.

10 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - FAMILY ALCOVE - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 8:32 AM

Russell sits in a plastic chair with a cup of water he hasn't touched, his whistle still around his neck. His hands are shaking now. Marc sits down next to him.

MARC
(low)
She has a pulse, Russ. Strong. Robert, Dr. Bullock, says your CPR is why.

RUSSELL
(staring at his hands)
I heard her ribs crack. Under my hands. On the third compression. It sounded like a bag of chips.

MARC
That means you were doing it right.

RUSSELL
(looking at him)
That's what they said in the class. I didn't believe it.

A beat.

RUSSELL
Does Elxa know I'm here?

MARC
She's in the OR with an appendix. I'll tell her the minute she's out.

RUSSELL
(half a laugh)
Twelve weeks pregnant, scrubbing an appendix at eight in the morning. That's your sister.

MARC
(very quietly, glancing around)
Careful. Walls have ears here.

RUSSELL
(lowering his voice)
Right. Right. Sorry. (beat) Dr. Bullock.

MARC
Coach.

They sit there together.

11 INT. PELL PAVILION - EMPLOYEE HEALTH CLINIC - EXAM ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 8:49 AM

A tiny exam room. DR. MARLENE FISK (57), Director of Employee Health, kind, brisk, with a cardigan and half-moon glasses, reads lab results. Arianna sits on the exam table, hugging herself.

DR. FISK
Rapid plasma reagin is positive. The confirmatory treponemal test is positive. You have syphilis, Dr. Cummings. Probably early latent. You don't have any symptoms, which is lucky.

ARIANNA
(flat)
Lucky.

DR. FISK
One shot of benzathine penicillin, two point four million units, intramuscular. In the buttock. It stings like a hornet. You'll be cured. (beat) Allergies to penicillin?

ARIANNA
No.

DR. FISK
Then drop your pants. (preparing the injection) The Department of Health asks every patient to identify their partners in the last three months, so they can be notified and treated. You can tell them yourself, or the DOH can notify them anonymously.

Arianna looks at the wall.

ARIANNA
(very quietly)
One person.

DR. FISK
(gently)
I need a name, Doctor. It's confidential. It's protected. It's public health.

A long pause.

ARIANNA
(barely audible)
She already knows. She was here this morning.

Dr. Fisk looks at her for a moment. Then nods, without any reaction at all, and swabs Arianna's hip with alcohol.

DR. FISK
Then that part's taken care of. (beat) Deep breath.

The needle goes in. Arianna doesn't flinch. A single tear runs down her face. It's not the shot.

12 INT. PELL PAVILION - 9TH FLOOR - VIP SUITE - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 9:05 AM

Natasha comes in alone, in her white coat, for a board member's courtesy visit. Mrs. Truitt sets the coffee cup she's been sniffing on the tray table.

MRS. TRUITT
Natasha. You didn't have to come up.

NATASHA
Evangeline, you've sat on my board for twenty-two years. You get the Chief. (beat) Dr. Lowery is the best hernia surgeon in Queens.

MRS. TRUITT
I'd rather have you.

NATASHA
You'd rather have someone who does hernias.

MRS. TRUITT
(beat, shrewd)
Sylvia tells me the deficit's forty-four million.

NATASHA
Sylvia tells everyone.

MRS. TRUITT
And you're still refusing your father's money.

NATASHA
(pleasant, firm)
Queens Grace isn't a Donohue charity.

MRS. TRUITT
(studying her)
You were always the stubborn one, even at twelve. (beat) Then take mine. One million. My late husband Harold's estate. Unrestricted. No names on any buildings. Just a check.

Natasha stops.

NATASHA
Evangeline...

MRS. TRUITT
It's not Donohue money, darling. It's Truitt money. And Harold would have liked the idea of saving a hospital in Queens just to annoy his brother, who's on the board at Lenox Hill.

Natasha laughs. The first real laugh she's had in weeks.

NATASHA
(beat)
Thank you.

MRS. TRUITT
It's not forty-four million. But it's a start.

13 INT. PELL PAVILION - 3RD FLOOR - SUPPLY ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 9:14 AM

Arianna, limping slightly from the shot, finds Kendra restocking gauze. She closes the door behind her.

ARIANNA
(low, furious)
You knew.

KENDRA
(not turning around)
I got the call from the DOH on Wednesday.

ARIANNA
Wednesday. It's Friday. You let me find out from a memo on the locker room door.

KENDRA
(turning)
I was going to tell you.

ARIANNA
When? At the party tonight?

KENDRA
(beat)
I didn't know how.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Who gave it to you?

Kendra's face changes. She looks at the floor.

KENDRA
Before you and me. Back in May. Before I knew what you... before. I was seeing someone. A guy. It wasn't serious. We stopped in June.

ARIANNA
Who?

KENDRA
(beat)
Andre.

Arianna stares at her.

ARIANNA
Andre. The paramedic. Who wheeled a girl in here two hours ago. That Andre.

KENDRA
(miserable)
He didn't know either. He was the first one diagnosed. He's the one who told the DOH to call me. He's been calling everybody he... (she stops)

Arianna's mind is working. Fast.

ARIANNA
(slowly)
"Everybody he."

She thinks of Harmony in the waiting room. "After the bridge." She thinks about who wheeled in the bridge victims. She closes her eyes.

ARIANNA
(under her breath)
Oh, Double-O.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

14 INT. PELL PAVILION - EMPLOYEE HEALTH CLINIC - EXAM ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 9:40 AM

Harmony on the exam table, scrub pants around her knees, eyes squeezed shut. Dr. Fisk wipes her hip with alcohol.

DR. FISK
Secondary syphilis. The rash on your palms is classic. One shot and you're cured. You'll probably run a fever tonight, chills, achy. It's called a Jarisch-Herxheimer reaction. It means the penicillin's working.

HARMONY
(eyes still shut)
Tonight's the party.

DR. FISK
(dry)
Then I'd skip the tequila. (beat) Partners in the last three months?

HARMONY
(whispering)
One.

DR. FISK
Name.

HARMONY
(beat, mortified)
Andre Fontaine. The paramedic. On the night of the bridge. He drove me home. We sat in the rig on 49th Avenue and talked for two hours about saving people, and then... (opening her eyes) He was so nice. He brought me a ginger ale. He held my hand.

DR. FISK
(gently)
Mr. Fontaine was the first case we identified. He's the one who came forward. He's been very responsible. He's already given the Department of Health your name.

HARMONY
(sitting bolt upright)
He gave them my NAME?

DR. FISK
Confidentially. So you'd be notified. That's how this works. (beat) That's him being decent, Dr. Divine. It doesn't feel like it. But it is.

The needle goes in. Harmony yelps.

HARMONY
(through her teeth)
That's a hornet.

DR. FISK
I tell everybody. Nobody believes me.

15 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 10:26 AM

The TV is on NY1. Amond, Raven and two other interns are eating breakfast sandwiches. Arianna comes in limping slightly and sits down very carefully on one hip. Harmony comes in a minute later, limping in exactly the same way, and sits down very carefully on the other end of the couch.

Amond looks from one to the other. Back. His eyebrows go up.

AMOND
(casually)
Same hip.

ARIANNA
(instantly)
Shut up.

HARMONY
(instantly)
Shut up.

Raven looks between them, confused. Then she gets it.

RAVEN
(whispering, horrified)
Oh, no.

AMOND
(picking up the remote, merciful for once)
Did everyone see the plane in Toronto? Air France. It went off the end of the runway in a thunderstorm on Tuesday and burst into flames. All three hundred and nine people got out alive.

RAVEN
(grateful for the subject change)
All of them?

AMOND
All of them. In ninety seconds. The flight attendants got everyone out before the fire took the cabin. Nobody died.

HARMONY
(quietly)
That's a miracle.

AMOND
It's not a miracle. It's training. They drill evacuations every six months. When the worst happened, nobody had to think.

He glances at Arianna and Harmony, both sitting very still on their sore hips.

AMOND
(beat, almost kind)
Everybody gets a bad landing. You walk away from it. That's the training.

16 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - CENTRAL STATION - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 10:51 AM

Elxa, out of the OR, scrub cap still on, walks fast into the Pit. She sees Russell sitting in the family alcove, whistle still around his neck. She stops.

ELXA
Russell.

He stands. They meet halfway across the Pit. Elxa, the Warden, the terror of the intern class, grabs her husband by the front of his T-shirt and pulls him into a fierce hug in front of the whole department. Nurses stop and stare.

ELXA
(into his chest)
Marc told me. You did CPR on a sixteen-year-old in the street for six minutes.

RUSSELL
I heard her ribs crack.

ELXA
(pulling back, holding his face)
You kept her alive, baby.

RUSSELL
(overwhelmed)
I teach chemistry.

ELXA
(fierce)
You're a hero, and you're the father of my child, and I'm going to tell everyone in this building.

She turns around. Half the Pit is watching. Gloria, at the station, raises her eyebrows.

ELXA
(loudly)
What? This is my husband. He saved a life this morning. Go back to work.

Everyone goes back to work. Gloria, smiling to herself, writes in a chart.

17 INT. PELL PAVILION - 9TH FLOOR - VIP SUITE - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 11:30 AM

Mrs. Truitt holds the paper Starbucks cup under her nose and inhales deeply, eyes closed, in ecstasy. Raven watches. Esther checks her vitals.

MRS. TRUITT
(eyes closed)
Heaven. You have no idea, darling. Fifty years of coffee every morning, and today this woman tells me "NPO."

ESTHER
(smiling)
Surgery's at one. Dr. Lowery will do the repair. Laparoscopic. You'll go home tomorrow.

MRS. TRUITT
I asked Natasha to do it herself.

ESTHER
She's an obstetrician, Mrs. Truitt.

MRS. TRUITT
She delivered my granddaughter in 1994. Breech. She can fix a hernia. (sighing) But she said no, in that voice.

There's a knock on the open door. Marc leans in with a chart.

MARC
Dr. Smilley, Dr. Ellison, Dr. Bullock wants the pre-op labs on 9 West. Elxa. The other Dr. Bullock...

Mrs. Truitt opens her eyes. She looks at Marc. Her whole face changes. She sets the coffee down.

MRS. TRUITT
(delighted)
Oh my LORD.

MARC
(freezing)
Ma'am?

MRS. TRUITT
Marc-Anthony! Natasha's boy! Look at you! The last time I saw you, you were eleven years old at your grandfather's Christmas party in Brookline, and you spilled punch on the Ambassador to Ghana!

Dead silence. Raven's mouth falls open. Esther turns very slowly to look at Marc. Marc stands in the doorway like a deer in headlights the size of a refrigerator.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

18 INT. PELL PAVILION - 9TH FLOOR - VIP SUITE - CONTINUOUS
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 11:31 AM

Marc's mouth opens. Nothing comes out. Mrs. Truitt looks at his face: the pure terror on it. Then at Esther. Then at Raven. Her expression shifts. She's been in rooms full of secrets for seventy years.

MARC
(strangled)
I think you have me confused with...

MRS. TRUITT
(without missing a beat)
...with my late husband Harold's nephew, Marc. Marcus. Lovely boy, terrible with punch. (waving a hand) Forgive me, darling. They gave me something at six this morning for my nerves, and my eyes are not what they were. All you tall young men look alike to me.

RAVEN
(relieved)
Oh! The pre-op sedation.

MRS. TRUITT
(sweetly)
Exactly, darling.

Esther doesn't look relieved. She looks at Mrs. Truitt. At Marc. At the chart in Marc's hand that he's gripping so hard the clipboard is bending.

MRS. TRUITT
(to Marc, perfectly pleasant)
Young man. Would you be a dear and stay a moment? I'd like to ask you about my labs. (to Esther and Raven) Ladies, go get those labs for the other Dr. Bullock.

Esther and Raven leave. Esther glances back at the door. Marc closes it.

19 INT. PELL PAVILION - 9TH FLOOR - VIP SUITE - CONTINUOUS
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 11:33 AM

MRS. TRUITT
(all business now)
Sit.

Marc sits.

MRS. TRUITT
How long have you been hiding?

MARC
(beat)
Five weeks.

MRS. TRUITT
(laughing softly)
Five weeks. In your own mother's hospital. Under your own father's name. With your sister as your resident. (shaking her head) Your grandfather must be beside himself.

MARC
He doesn't like it.

MRS. TRUITT
He wouldn't. Victor's never understood why anyone would want to be anything other than a Donohue. (beat) Why, baby?

MARC
(quiet)
Because I want to know if I'm any good. Not if I'm a Donohue. If I'm good. And I want people to like me without wondering what I can do for them.

Mrs. Truitt looks at him for a long time.

MRS. TRUITT
(softening)
I married money twice, darling. I know exactly what that's like. (beat) Your secret is safe with me. I never saw you. I'm a very sedated old woman.

MARC
Thank you, Mrs. Truitt.

MRS. TRUITT
(raising a finger)
But I'll tell you something I learned in seventy years in rooms like this one. Secrets in families like ours always come out. Always. And never at a good time. (beat) You might want to choose the time yourself, before somebody chooses it for you.

20 INT. PELL PAVILION - 9TH FLOOR CORRIDOR - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 11:41 AM

Marc comes out of the VIP suite. Esther is waiting at the end of the hall. Alone. Arms crossed. Raven is nowhere.

ESTHER
Raven believed her. Pre-op sedation.

MARC
(carefully)
That's what it was.

ESTHER
She hasn't had any pre-op sedation. I checked her MAR. She's had nothing but saline and a lot of coffee fumes.

Marc doesn't answer.

ESTHER
(quiet)
"Natasha's boy." Your grandfather's Christmas party in Brookline. The Ambassador to Ghana.

MARC
Esther.

ESTHER
The seven-bedroom brownstone. The Chief stopping in the Pit to talk to you. The way Elxa looks at you. (beat) You told me you'd never lie to the people you take care of.

MARC
I'm not lying to you.

ESTHER
You're not telling me.

A long pause. Marc looks at her. Really looks at her.

MARC
(quietly)
Can it be something I tell you later? When I'm ready. I promise I'll tell you. Just... not in a hallway outside a VIP suite.

Esther looks at him for a long moment. Her hand drifts, almost unconsciously, to her collarbone. To the chain under her scrubs. Her own secret.

ESTHER
(beat)
Yes.

MARC
Yes?

ESTHER
(softly)
I'm not exactly in a position to demand everything from you right now. (beat) Later. You promised.

MARC
I promised.

21 EXT. PELL PAVILION - AMBULANCE BAY - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 12:22 PM

Hot midday. FDNY rig 47 sits in the bay. Andre Fontaine restocks the rig, sweating. Tee Rollins sits on the back bumper eating a sandwich. Arianna walks straight up to Andre.

ARIANNA
Fontaine.

ANDRE
(looking up, wary)
Doc.

ARIANNA
(low, hard)
Kendra. And Harmony Divine.

Tee stops chewing. Andre's face goes gray. He puts down the box of saline.

ANDRE
(quiet)
I know.

ARIANNA
You KNOW?

ANDRE
I got diagnosed three weeks ago. I went to the clinic on Jackson Avenue. I've been calling everyone. Everyone. Every single person I was with since spring. I gave the DOH every name I had. (beat) I didn't know, Doc. I swear to God, I didn't know. I didn't have a single symptom. Not one.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You gave it to Kendra in May. Kendra gave it to... (stops)

ANDRE
(gently)
To you.

Arianna freezes. Tee looks away politely.

ANDRE
Kendra told me. Two weeks ago, when I told her. She asked me to keep it to myself, and I did. (beat) I'm sorry, Doc. I'm sorry for all of it.

Arianna stands in the heat, fists clenched, ready to crash out. She looks at him: a twenty-seven-year-old paramedic who's spent three weeks making the most humiliating phone calls of his life because it was the right thing to do.

ARIANNA
(deflating, exhausted)
You called everybody?

ANDRE
Fourteen people. One of them was my ex-fiancée. She hung up on me four times before she let me finish.

ARIANNA
(beat)
That's... actually decent.

ANDRE
(half a smile)
It didn't feel decent.

TEE
(to Arianna, mouth full)
He's a good one, Doc. He's just a dummy. (beat) Like everybody.

22 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 7 - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 1:12 PM

Mrs. Truitt on the table, the anesthesiologist placing the mask over her face. DR. ABRAHAM LOWERY (58), a dapper attending general surgeon, scrubs in at the side. Esther is gowned and gloved, ready to assist.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
Mrs. Truitt, I want you to count backward from ten.

MRS. TRUITT
(through the mask, dreamy)
Darling, I'm going to sing instead.

And she does, in a faded but still lovely alto: "Stormy Weather." The OR goes quiet and listens.

MRS. TRUITT
(fading)
"...don't know why... there's no sun up in the sky..."

She's out. The room exhales.

DR. LOWERY
(to Esther)
She sang at the Apollo in 1953, you know. The chorus line, back row. She tells everybody.

ESTHER
(smiling)
She told me she's been in less than my poster.

DR. LOWERY
(laughing)
That's Evangeline. (beat) Ports, Dr. Smilley. Let's fix the diva's hernia.

23 INT. PELL PAVILION - 4TH FLOOR - ON-CALL ROOM 4C - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 1:47 PM

Harmony, in the bottom bunk, curled up facing the wall, shivering under a thin hospital blanket. The fever's started. The broken-lock door opens. Marc comes in with a cup of ginger ale and two Tylenol.

MARC
Raven said you were in here.

HARMONY
(not turning over)
Go away. I have syphilis.

MARC
(sitting on the floor against the wall)
Had. You had syphilis. Past tense. You got the shot. The shivering is the penicillin killing it. It's called a Herx reaction.

HARMONY
(muffled)
I know what it's called, Marc. I'm a doctor.

MARC
Then take the Tylenol, Doctor.

She rolls over. Her face is splotchy from crying. She takes the Tylenol and the ginger ale. She drinks.

HARMONY
(quiet)
I've been with three people in my life. Alicia, a boy in college, and Andre. Three. And the third one gave me a disease from 1492.

MARC
(gently)
It's older than 1492, actually. That's a myth.

HARMONY
(beat, glaring)
Not now, Marc.

MARC
Sorry.

Beat.

HARMONY
I wanted it to mean something. That night. After the bridge. I thought maybe I wasn't just the girl who freezes. Maybe somebody would look at me like... (she stops)

MARC
Like what?

Harmony looks at him. The man she's in love with, sitting on the floor of a call room, completely clueless.

HARMONY
(looking away)
Like they look at Esther.

Marc doesn't understand what she's really saying. He thinks she's talking about Andre.

MARC
(kindly)
Harmony. You're not the girl who freezes. You're the girl who stuck a needle in a man's chest and saved his life. You're the girl who did a whole appendectomy skin to skin with the Warden watching. (beat) And anybody who doesn't look at you like that is an idiot.

Harmony smiles a little through the tears. It's not the right kind of comfort, but it's kind. And it's him.

HARMONY
(beat)
Are you still having the party?

MARC
Raven printed a hundred flyers. Miss Hattie is bringing potato salad. Nobody can stop it now.

HARMONY
(sniffling)
I don't want to go.

MARC
Then sit on the stoop. It's your house too.

24 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - BED 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 4:10 PM

Imani, still intubated, sedated, cooling blankets. Her mother hasn't moved. Amond comes to check the monitors. Around Imani's wrist, someone has tied a ribbon in the step team's colors, red and gray.

CHERYL
(not looking up)
Her teammates came. They left that.

AMOND
(checking the drips)
Her rhythm's been stable for nine hours. No more V-tach.

CHERYL
Dr. Baker. When she wakes up, will you be the one to tell her? About the stepping?

Amond stops.

AMOND
(beat)
I'm the intern. Dr. Bullock will...

CHERYL
You're the one who said it to me. Straight. You didn't wrap it up in cotton. (beat) She's like you. She's going to want it straight.

Amond looks at Imani. At the ribbon.

AMOND
(quietly)
Okay.

25 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - FRONT DOOR - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 9:14 PM

The house is transformed. Lights in every window. Music pumping through the walls: Mariah's "We Belong Together." People spilling out onto the stoop with plastic cups. Raven, in a sundress, has commandeered the door like a club bouncer.

Up the stoop, in a church-going summer dress and her good earrings, carrying a covered dish of peach cobbler, climbs Nurse Gloria Pettiford.

RAVEN
(thrilled)
GLORIA! You came!

GLORIA
(handing her the cobbler)
You put a flyer in my mailbox at work, Ellison. Nobody's done that since 1987. I had to come.

She steps inside. She stops in the front hallway and looks up: the twelve-foot ceilings, the crown molding, the staircase curving up four floors, the fireplace in the parlor. She takes it all in. Slowly.

GLORIA
(to herself)
Mm-hm.

She walks into the kitchen. It's crowded with interns, nurses and residents. She sets her purse down and opens a drawer, looking for a bottle opener.

In the drawer, under a stack of takeout menus, face up, is a framed photograph. She picks it up.

The photo: a Harvard Medical School commencement, about 1984. A young NATASHA DONOHUE in a cap and gown, beaming. Holding her hand, about five years old, in a little bow tie and a tiny blazer, with an enormous dimpled grin: a little boy who can only be Marc-Anthony. And beside them, a tall, silver-haired man with his hand on the boy's head: DR. VICTOR DONOHUE.

Gloria looks at the photo for a long time. She looks up. Across the crowded kitchen, through the doorway, Marc is in the parlor laughing with Raven, holding a plate of Miss Hattie's potato salad.

Gloria puts the photo back in the drawer, face down. Closes the drawer.

GLORIA
(very quietly)
Lord, have mercy.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

26 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - PARLOR - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 9:47 PM

The party is in full swing. Fifty people in a parlor meant for twenty. Missy Elliott's "Lose Control" thumps from a borrowed sound system. Nurses dance by the fireplace. Two residents argue about the Yankees.

Miss Hattie Lomax (60) presides over a folding table like a general: potato salad, fried chicken, Gloria's peach cobbler, a tray of Raven's perfect grilled cheeses cut into triangles.

The front door opens. Lillian Divine (53), in her church hat, carrying two foil trays of macaroni and cheese, sweeps in.

HARMONY
(from the stoop, horrified)
MOMMY? Who invited you?

LILLIAN
(sweeping past her)
A flyer on the bulletin board at your hospital said "bring a dish, bring a friend." I brought two dishes and myself.

She sets her trays down next to Miss Hattie's potato salad. The two women look at each other across the table.

MISS HATTIE
(nodding)
Gouda.

LILLIAN
(nodding back)
Paprika on top of the potato salad. You're a professional.

They shake hands. A truce among titans. Raven, watching, puts a hand over her heart.

27 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - PARLOR - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 10:05 PM

Elxa sits on the giant sofa, shoes off, feet up, a plate of cobbler balanced on her belly, which isn't showing yet. Russell sits beside her with his arm around her. She sinks

deeper into the cushions.

ELXA
(to Marc, who's passing with ice)
You were right. It's a fantastic couch.

MARC
I told you.

ELXA
Where did you get it?

MARC
(beat)
It came with the house.

ELXA
(dry, knowing exactly where it came from)
Mm.

Raven stands on a chair and clinks a plastic cup with a fork.

RAVEN
Everybody! EVERYBODY! (the room quiets) This morning, at a step practice in Jamaica, a sixteen-year-old girl's heart stopped. And a chemistry teacher, who took a CPR class in June because the school made him, got down on the blacktop and pushed on her chest for six minutes until the paramedics came. (pointing) Russell Jeffries, everybody!

The room erupts. Russell turns red to the tips of his ears. Elxa beams like the sun and squeezes his hand.

RUSSELL
(overwhelmed, to Elxa)
I teach chemistry.

ELXA
(kissing his cheek)
You keep saying that like it means something.

28 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 10:32 PM

Marc comes into the kitchen for more cups. Gloria is there alone, leaning against the counter, sipping a ginger ale. She's waiting for him.

GLORIA
Nice house.

MARC
(wary)
Thanks.

GLORIA
(pleasant)
Twelve-foot ceilings. Original molding. A four-story Hunters Point brownstone, double lot. On a forty-four-thousand-dollar salary.

MARC
(beat)
My parents really like me.

GLORIA
(beat)
I know they do, baby. (beat) Your mama has very good taste in picture frames.

Marc freezes. He looks at the drawer. Back at Gloria.

MARC
(very quietly)
Gloria.

GLORIA
(calm)
I told you two weeks ago. Whatever it is, it's safe with me. Now I know what it is, and it's still safe. (beat) I've known that woman twelve years. I watched her walk through my Pit every night with nobody to go home to, because her husband was in the OR and her kids were grown and gone. And then this summer, she started walking through with her face lit up. (beat) Now I know why.

Marc doesn't know what to say.

GLORIA
(setting down the ginger ale)
I'm not going to say anything. Not to anybody. But you need to hear this from somebody who isn't family. (beat) This is a hospital. Secrets are bad for hospitals. They make people make bad calls. One day yours is going to cost somebody something. Make sure you tell it before that.

MARC
(beat)
That's the second time today someone's told me that.

GLORIA
(picking up her purse)
Then maybe God's trying to tell you something, baby. (beat) The cobbler's mine. Bring my dish back Monday.

29 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - KITCHEN - UPPER WEST SIDE - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 10:40 PM

A warm, lived-in kitchen on Riverside Drive. Robert, in reading glasses, sits at the island with a neon-orange flyer someone left on his desk. Natasha comes in from the hallway, barefoot, in a robe, and pours two glasses of wine.

ROBERT
(reading)
"Hosted by Raven, Harmony and, technically, Marc." (beat) Our son is throwing a party in our house.

NATASHA
His house.

ROBERT
The deed says 49th Avenue Holdings LLC.

NATASHA
Which belongs to my father, who gave it to our son, who is currently using it to host sixty of my employees.

ROBERT
(beat)
Should we go?

NATASHA
(instantly)
Absolutely not.

ROBERT
(grinning)
I'd like to see him try to explain us.

NATASHA
He'd say we're "the landlords." (handing him a glass) Gloria Pettiford is there.

ROBERT
(beat)
Gloria knows.

NATASHA
Gloria's known since July. She's a better detective than half the NYPD. (beat) Evangeline Truitt offered me a million dollars today. Unrestricted.

ROBERT
(setting down his glass)
And?

NATASHA
I said yes. (beat) It's not Donohue money.

Robert gets up, goes to the old CD player on the counter, and presses play. Frankie Beverly and Maze. "Before I Let Go." Natasha closes her eyes and laughs.

NATASHA
Robert. We're forty-seven and forty-nine.

ROBERT
(holding out his hand)
And it's the law.

She takes his hand. They dance in their kitchen, barefoot and in reading glasses, exactly like the twenty-year-olds they once were at a Howard house party in 1976.

30 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 10:51 PM

The front door opens. Andre Fontaine, in a clean shirt, holding a six-pack, stands on the stoop. Raven invited him, like she invited everyone. He sees who's sitting there: Harmony, wrapped in a blanket and shivering with fever, and next to her, Arianna.

Behind them, through the window, Kendra is in the parlor. She sees him too.

Nobody says anything. The music thumps inside: 50 Cent's "Candy Shop," which is suddenly the worst song in the world.

ANDRE
(beat, quiet)
I'm going to go.

HARMONY
(beat)
You can stay.

Arianna and Andre both look at her.

HARMONY
(pulling the blanket tighter)
You called everybody. You told the truth. That's more than most people do. (beat) Just... don't sit next to me.

Andre nods slowly. He sets the six-pack on the stoop, between Harmony and Arianna.

ANDRE
(quiet)
For the house. (beat) I'm sorry, Harmony. You deserved better than a disease and a ginger ale.

HARMONY
(beat)
It was a good ginger ale.

Andre almost laughs. He turns and walks away down 49th Avenue. Arianna watches him go.

ARIANNA
(low)
That was big of you.

HARMONY
(shivering)
I have a fever of a hundred and one. I'm delirious.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Either way.

31 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - FRONT HALLWAY - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 11:05 PM

The doorbell rings. Raven opens it. On the stoop stands Dr. Leland Graves (52) in a linen shirt, holding a bottle of very good wine. Behind Raven, the entire party freezes. Somebody turns the music down.

RAVEN
(stunned)
Dr. Graves?

GRAVES
(holding up a neon-orange flyer)
It was under my office door. "Bring a dish." (handing her the wine) I don't cook.

He steps in. Fifty interns, nurses and residents stare at the Chief of Neurosurgery as if a lion had wandered into the living room.

GRAVES
(to the room, dry)
As you were.

Nobody moves. Miss Hattie, at the food table, points her spoon at him.

MISS HATTIE
Leland Graves. You come over here and eat something. You've been eating out of that vending machine since 1991.

The Chief of Neurosurgery walks obediently to the food table. Miss Hattie fills a plate for him. He takes a bite of her potato salad and closes his eyes.

GRAVES
(quietly, reverent)
Hattie.

MISS HATTIE
I know.

The music comes back up. The party breathes again. In the corner, Esther watches her mentor eat potato salad and grins.

32 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - PARLOR - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 11:20 PM

Somebody puts on Frankie Beverly and Maze, "Before I Let Go," and the whole room screams. It's the law: when that song comes on at a Black party, everyone gets up. Even Amond, dragged up by two nurses, does an extremely reluctant two-step. Miss Hattie and Lillian dance together. Elxa does the Electric Slide from the couch with her arms only.

Esther arrives late, in jeans and a simple white top, her hair down. She stands in the doorway taking it all in. Marc sees her from across the room. He crosses through the crowd.

MARC
(over the music)
You came.

ESTHER
(over the music)
Raven put a flyer under my windshield wiper. On my BIKE.

MARC
(laughing)
She's thorough.

ESTHER
(looking at the dancing crowd)
What is this?

MARC
This is Frankie Beverly. You're legally obligated.

He holds out his hand. She hesitates... then takes it. He spins her into the crowd. She laughs, a real one, head thrown back. They dance, and they're good together, natural, falling into rhythm like they've done it a hundred times.

The song ends. Without a pause, the DJ, a resident with a laptop, switches to Mariah Carey. "We Belong Together." Slow.

Couples pair off. Marc and Esther are standing in the middle of the floor, still holding hands. A moment. Then she steps in, and they slow-dance, close, her head nearly on his shoulder.

On the stairs, Harmony watches them, wrapped in her blanket. Raven sits down next to her without a word and puts an arm around her.

Halfway through the song, Esther stiffens. She steps back.

ESTHER
(quietly)
I can't.

MARC
(gently)
I know.

ESTHER
(looking at him, her eyes bright)
You keep saying you know. You don't know.

MARC
I know you're not available. I know it's complicated. I know it's something in Boston that isn't finished. (beat) I'm not asking for anything, Esther. It's just a song.

ESTHER
(whispering)
It's not just a song. That's the problem.

She squeezes his hand once and goes. Out the front door, past Harmony and Raven on the stairs, into the night.

33 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 5, 2005 - 11:46 PM

Arianna gets a drink from the fridge. Kendra comes in behind her. They stand at opposite ends of the kitchen island.

KENDRA
I should have told you on Wednesday.

ARIANNA
Yeah.

KENDRA
I was ashamed.

ARIANNA
(beat)
So was I. Today. In that waiting room. Six people I work with, all pretending we didn't see each other. (beat) And then Fisk asked me for a name, and I almost lied. Because if I said your name, it was real. Me and you. On a Department of Health form.

KENDRA
(soft)
Is it real?

Arianna looks at her for a long time. In the parlor, the music has gone back to something with a beat.

ARIANNA
(beat)
We both got shot in the butt with penicillin on the same day. If that's not real, I don't know what is.

Kendra laughs. Then she crosses the kitchen. Arianna doesn't move away. Kendra kisses her, quickly, softly. Arianna kisses her back.

In the doorway, Raven freezes with an empty tray, and immediately backs out of the room.

RAVEN (O.S.)
(to someone in the hallway)
Nope! Kitchen's closed!

34 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - ROOF DECK - NIGHT
SATURDAY, AUGUST 6, 2005 - 12:22 AM

The roof deck: string lights, two lawn chairs, and the Manhattan skyline across the river, close enough to touch. Marc sits alone, looking at it. The door opens. Amond comes out with two plastic cups of punch. He sits in the other chair.

AMOND
I danced.

MARC
I saw. You were terrible.

AMOND
I was technically proficient. (beat) Esther left.

MARC
Yeah.

A long pause. Amond looks out at the skyline.

AMOND
You said "Donohue" this morning. About the couch. Then you changed it to "doozy."

MARC
(very still)
It's a brand.

AMOND
It's not a brand. I checked. (beat) This house. The Chief stopping in the Pit. Robert Bullock watching you a beat too long when you walk out of the room. Elxa. The "common name." Lawrence Donohue asking about you on speakerphone. (beat) I'm a scientist, Bullock. I look at data. I don't believe in coincidences.

Marc closes his eyes.

AMOND
(quiet)
Natasha Donohue is your mother.

A long, long silence. The skyline glitters. Somewhere below, the party thumps on.

MARC
(barely audible)
Yeah.

AMOND
And Robert Bullock is your father.

MARC
Yeah.

AMOND
And Victor Donohue is your grandfather. The Donohue Valve. The Foundation. Three hundred billion dollars.

MARC
(opening his eyes)
Yeah.

Amond takes a long drink of punch. Sets it down.

AMOND
(beat)
And you're eating vending-machine peanut butter crackers with me on the hospital roof at two in the morning.

MARC
They're good crackers.

AMOND
(looking at him)
Why?

MARC
(quiet)
Because I want to find out if I'm any good. And I wanted one person in that hospital to be my friend without knowing.

Amond looks at him for a long time.

AMOND
(beat)
I'm still your friend. Now I know. That's better data.

MARC
(emotional)
You're not going to tell anyone?

AMOND
(disgusted)
I don't gossip, Bullock. I'm not Raven. (beat) Besides. You're my day one. Apparently. You said so on the roof. It's binding.

Marc laughs. Wipes his eyes.

MARC
(beat)
You're the first one I've told.

AMOND
You didn't tell me. I figured it out.

MARC
That's worse.

AMOND
(smug)
That's better.

35 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
SATURDAY, AUGUST 6, 2005 - 12:58 AM

An NYPD patrol car from the 108th Precinct pulls up out front. OFFICER DELROY MATHIS (38) gets out and walks up to the stoop, where Raven and Big Ray Toles (45) are sitting with plates of cobbler.

OFFICER MATHIS
Evening. We got a noise complaint from 49th Avenue. Somebody says there's a "Frankie Beverly emergency" in progress.

BIG RAY
(standing, extending a hand)
Delroy.

OFFICER MATHIS
(surprised, shaking it)
Big Ray? I didn't know you lived here.

BIG RAY
I don't. These are my doctors. From Queens Grace. They saved forty-three people off the bridge last month. Tonight they're blowing off some steam.

Officer Mathis looks at the house. At the music. At Raven, holding up her plate.

RAVEN
(sweetly)
Would you like some peach cobbler, Officer?

A beat.

OFFICER MATHIS
(sighing)
Turn it down to a seven. And yes, ma'am.

ACT FIVE

36 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - BED 2 - DAY
SATURDAY, AUGUST 6, 2005 - 7:12 AM

Morning. The cooling blankets are gone. The breathing tube is out. Imani Batts is awake, groggy, hoarse, the red-and-gray ribbon still on her wrist. Her mother is holding her hand. Amond stands at the foot of the bed, still slightly hungover, in fresh scrubs. Robert stands behind him.

IMANI
(hoarse)
Did we place?

CHERYL
(laughing and crying)
Baby, you were DEAD.

IMANI
(confused)
At regionals?

Robert nods to Amond: your patient.

AMOND
Imani. I'm Dr. Baker. Can you squeeze my hand? (she does) Wiggle your toes? (she does) Do you know where you are?

IMANI
(hoarse)
Hospital. Queens Grace. My coach was on top of me. I remember him counting.

AMOND
He did CPR on you for six minutes. Your heart stopped. You have something called hypertrophic cardiomyopathy. Your heart muscle is too thick, and it can go into a dangerous rhythm without warning. That's what happened at practice.

IMANI
(beat)
Okay. When can I step again?

Cheryl looks at Amond. He doesn't look away.

AMOND
(straight)
Next week, we're going to put a small defibrillator in your chest. An ICD. If your heart ever goes into that rhythm again, it'll shock you back. It could save your life.

IMANI
Okay. And then I can step?

AMOND
(beat)
No. Not competitively. Not track either. The guidelines say people with your kind of heart shouldn't do high-intensity competitive sports. Because the next time, you might not have a coach right there who took a CPR class.

Imani stares at him. Her eyes fill.

IMANI
(barely audible)
I'm the captain.

AMOND
I know.

IMANI
I've been stepping since I was nine.

AMOND
(beat)
I know.

Silence. Robert watches Amond, saying nothing.

AMOND
(quietly)
Imani. You're alive. That's the first thing. The second thing is that a coach doesn't have to be the one on the blacktop. Somebody has to design the routines. Somebody has to call the count. (beat) The guy who did CPR on you called the count. He's a chemistry teacher.

IMANI
(half a laugh, half a sob)
Mr. Jeffries.

AMOND
He can't step at all. And he got you to regionals.

Imani turns her face into her mother's shoulder and cries. Cheryl holds her. Amond stands there and doesn't leave.

37 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - CORRIDOR - DAY
SATURDAY, AUGUST 6, 2005 - 7:31 AM

ROBERT
(walking beside Amond)
You told her straight.

AMOND
Her mother asked me to.

ROBERT
And then you gave her somewhere to go. That's the part most people forget. You don't take something away without giving them a place to put their hands.

Amond nods. Then:

AMOND
(casually)
Dr. Bullock. Your son is a terrible liar.

Robert stops walking. He turns and looks at Amond for a long moment.

ROBERT
(very evenly)
I don't know what you're talking about, Dr. Baker.

AMOND
(nodding)
Neither do I, sir. I've never known anything about anything.

Robert looks at him a beat longer. Then the faintest smile.

ROBERT
(walking on)
Good.

38 INT. PELL PAVILION - 9TH FLOOR - VIP SUITE - DAY
SATURDAY, AUGUST 6, 2005 - 10:40 AM

Mrs. Truitt, discharged, sits in a wheelchair in a lavender summer suit and a wide-brimmed hat, holding a REAL grande Starbucks she's finally allowed to drink. Raven gathers her flowers. Marc wheels her toward the door.

MRS. TRUITT
(sipping, closing her eyes)
Glory.

RAVEN
How do you feel, Mrs. Truitt?

MRS. TRUITT
Like a woman who's had her innards rearranged by a very handsome surgeon and is now drinking coffee. Which is to say, magnificent.

At the elevator, Raven goes ahead to hold the door. Mrs. Truitt reaches up and presses a heavy cream-colored card into Marc's hand.

MRS. TRUITT
(low)
My card. When you're ready to stop hiding, darling, my door is open. I'll throw you a party that makes last night look like a church picnic.

MARC
(smiling)
You heard about last night?

MRS. TRUITT
(sipping)
Baby, I'm on the board. I hear about everything. (beat) And tell your grandfather he still owes me a dance from 1971.

39 INT. PELL PAVILION - CARDIAC ICU - BED 2 - DAY
SATURDAY, AUGUST 6, 2005 - 11:20 AM

Imani sits up in bed, puffy-eyed, the red-and-gray ribbon still on her wrist. A knock. Russell stands in the doorway with a stack of composition notebooks, looking deeply nervous.

RUSSELL
Hey, Captain.

IMANI
(hoarse, tearing up instantly)
Mr. Jeffries.

He comes in and sits. He sets the notebooks on her tray table.

RUSSELL
I heard. The doctor told me. No more competing.

IMANI
(crying)
I'm the captain.

RUSSELL
You're still the captain. (opening a notebook) These are every routine we've done since you were a freshman. I wrote down every count. Every hit. (beat) Regionals are in October. I can't step. I've got two left feet and a bad knee. I need somebody to build the routine. Somebody who can hear it.

Imani looks at the notebooks. At him.

IMANI
(beat)
You want me to choreograph?

RUSSELL
I want you to coach. With me. From a chair, if that's what it takes.

She wipes her face. Pulls the notebook closer. Flips through the pages: the counts, the stomps, the claps.

IMANI
(sniffling, pointing)
This eight-count is wrong. It's always been wrong.

RUSSELL
(smiling)
Then fix it, Coach.

TAG

40 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - PARLOR - DAY
SATURDAY, AUGUST 6, 2005 - 12:41 PM

The morning after. The parlor is a disaster: plastic cups everywhere, an empty foil tray, someone's sandal under the radiator, a single feather boa no one can explain. Raven and Harmony (fever gone, color back) are wrapped in blankets on the fantastic couch. Marc lies on the floor in front of them, staring at the ceiling. Amond is asleep in the armchair with his mouth open.

RAVEN
(staring at the ceiling too)
That was the best party in the history of Queens.

HARMONY
My mother and Miss Hattie exchanged phone numbers.

RAVEN
A cop ate three plates of cobbler.

MARC
Arianna kissed Kendra in our kitchen.

RAVEN
(sitting up)
YOU SAW THAT?

MARC
Everybody saw that. You yelled "kitchen's closed" like a fire alarm.

Harmony laughs. Then quiets. She looks at Marc on the floor.

HARMONY
(softly)
Did Esther have fun?

Marc doesn't answer for a moment.

MARC
(quiet)
I think so. For one song.

Harmony looks at him. The thing she'll never say sits behind her eyes. She pulls the blanket up.

HARMONY
One song's something.

In the armchair, Amond wakes with a snort, looks around, and says, completely deadpan:

AMOND
This couch is a Donohue.

Marc throws a pillow at him. Raven and Harmony look at each other, confused. Amond goes back to sleep.

MARC (V.O.)
Every party ends with a mess.
Somebody's always left a shoe.
Somebody always kissed somebody
in the kitchen.

MARC (V.O.)
And by morning, everybody knows a
little more about everybody than
they did the night before.

41 EXT. WORLD'S FAIR MARINA - FLUSHING BAY - THE SAILBOAT "CLARENCE" - DAY
SATURDAY, AUGUST 6, 2005 - 1:05 PM

Esther sits in the cockpit of her boat, cradling a mug of tea, still in last night's white top. The phone buzzes on the bench: CLAYTON. It rings. And rings.

This time, she picks it up. She doesn't say anything. Just listens. We don't hear the other end.

ESTHER
(finally, steady)
Not yet, Clayton. (beat) When I'm
ready. Not before.

She hangs up. Sets the phone down. Looks out at the water.

MARC (V.O.)
The trick isn't keeping your
secrets.

MARC (V.O.)
It's choosing who gets to know
them. And when.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 1x05

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Friday, August 5, 2005, 6:31 AM

"Saw the memo on the locker room door. Here's my policy, Queens: I will NEVER post a name, a hint or a guess about who's positive. Not today, not ever. That's not gossip, that's somebody's health. Go to Employee Health, it's free and it's confidential. ALSO: the 49th Ave housewarming is TONIGHT. Bring a dish." Comments (29).

NY1: Health Watch with Dana Whitlock

Friday, August 5, 2005, 6:50 PM

"City health officials say syphilis, once nearly eliminated in New York, has been climbing since 2000. The Health Department is urging New Yorkers to get tested; treatment is a single shot of penicillin. 'Most people with early syphilis don't know they have it,' one official said. 'The only way to know is to get tested.'" *(Dana Whitlock's on-screen debut as NY1's health reporter.)*

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS: CHEM TEACHER'S CPR SAVES STEP CAPTAIN

Saturday, August 6, 2005

A Jamaica High School chemistry teacher is being credited with saving the life of a 16-year-old step team captain who collapsed in cardiac arrest during a summer practice yesterday morning.

Russell Jeffries, 30, began CPR within seconds, and a teammate retrieved the school's automated external defibrillator from the gym door. "I teach chemistry," Jeffries said, repeatedly. The girl was in stable condition at Queens Grace Hospital.

Sidebar: "Every school should have one": city councilmembers renew calls for AEDs in all public schools.

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Marc-Anthony Bullock and Esther Smilley)

Saturday, August 6, 2005, 1:14 AM

Marc: "thank you for the song."

(Delivered. No reply for 41 minutes.)

Esther (1:55 AM): "thank you for the song."

AIM: away message, AortaOrBust79 (Amond Baker)

Saturday, August 6, 2005, 1:38 AM

"Danced. Against my will. Learned things. Will never speak of either."

MySpace: bulletin from RavenE_Savannah

Saturday, August 6, 2005, 2:12 AM. Mood: ecstatic

"BEST. PARTY. EVER. 60+ people, 2 mac and cheeses, 1 peace treaty between Miss Hattie and Mrs. Divine, 1 NYPD officer who ate 3 plates of cobbler, and 0 people allowed in the kitchen after 11:45 (don't ask). 49th Ave, we love you. Pics coming when I get them developed at Rite Aid." Comments (44)

BlackBerry email: from R. Bullock to N. Donohue

Saturday, August 6, 2005, 7:35 AM. Subject: Baker

"Baker knows. He told me our son is a terrible liar. Then he told me he's never known anything about anything. He's a vault. I like him more every day. Also: Evangeline Truitt called me at 6 AM to say she 'never saw' our son. That makes four people this summer. R."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 1x05

New Canon Established

- **The syphilis outbreak:** Employee Health memo dated August 4, 2005. Chain: Andre Fontaine (diagnosed about mid-July; he notified 14 partners) to Kendra Wallace (May), then Kendra to Arianna; and Andre to Harmony (one night, July 17, after the bridge). All three were treated with benzathine penicillin G, 2.4 million units IM, on August 5. Harmony had a Jarisch-Herxheimer reaction (fever).
- **Arianna and Kendra are reconciled** and kissed in the kitchen at the party (seen by Raven; Marc says 'everybody saw'). They are now an acknowledged couple among the interns.
- **The housewarming party** (Friday, August 5, 9:00 PM to 1:00 AM-plus): about 60 guests. Miss Hattie and Lillian Divine made a truce and swapped numbers. The NYPD 108th Precinct (Officer Delroy Mathis) answered a noise complaint and left with cobbler. 'Before I Let Go' makes everyone get up.
- **Marc and Esther danced** to Frankie Beverly, then to 'We Belong Together.' She left mid-song: 'It's not just a song. That's the problem.' They texted 'thank you for the song' at 1:14 AM and 1:55 AM.
- **Esther suspects Marc's identity** after Mrs. Truitt's slip ('Natasha's boy'). Marc promised to tell her 'later,' and she agreed, because she has her own secret. She answered Clayton's call: 'Not yet, Clayton. When I'm ready.'
- **Amond knows.** He figured it out on the roof deck at 12:22 AM, August 6, and Marc confirmed it. He's the first person Marc has confirmed it to outside the family and Bernie. He's told Robert he's 'a vault.'
- **Gloria has confirmed it** by finding the 1984 Harvard Medical School commencement photo (Natasha, 5-year-old Marc, Victor) in the kitchen drawer. She told Marc, 'Secrets are bad for hospitals.' She's keeping it safe.
- **Mrs. Evangeline Truitt** (QGH board member for 22 years) knew Marc as a child: Victor's 1990 Christmas party in Brookline, where he spilled punch on the Ambassador to Ghana. She covered for him and told him to choose his own time to reveal it. Victor 'owes her a dance from 1971.'
- **Harmony's crush** continues; Marc remains unaware. Her sexual history: Alicia, a college boyfriend, Andre.
- **Raven learned from Monty** that Marc and Esther left the bar together on June 30. **Natasha accepted Evangeline Truitt's $1 million unrestricted gift** (Truitt money, not Donohue money). **Graves came to the party**, and Miss Hattie fed him. **Imani will co-coach** the step team with Russell for October regionals. **Russell Jeffries is a public hero** (Daily News). Elxa hugged him in front of the whole Pit.

Knowledge Tracker: Marc's True Identity (as of August 6, 2005)

Knows	Suspects	Doesn't know
Family, Bernie, Graves, Gloria (confirmed), Mrs. Truitt, Amond (confirmed)	Esther (promised 'later'), Crump, Arianna (smelled something in episode 1)	Raven (believes it was sedation), Harmony, Monty, Celia and others; Julian Whitmore (not yet introduced; per C-073, one of the last)

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Imani Batts	3/30/1989 (16)	Out-of-hospital cardiac arrest (VT/VF) from hypertrophic cardiomyopathy (septum 31 mm, SAM, LVOT obstruction)	Bystander CPR (Russell), AED x2, ED defibrillation (Robert; Amond, Marc), therapeutic hypothermia	Neurologically intact. ICD planned next week. No competitive sports
Evangeline Truitt	12/1/1934 (70)	Inguinal hernia	Laparoscopic repair (Dr. Abraham Lowery)	Discharged August 6
QGH staff (several)	-	Syphilis (secondary or early latent)	Benzathine penicillin G (Dr. Fisk)	Treated; partners notified through NYC DOH

New Characters (to add to MA-005 and MA-006)

- **Dr. Marlene Fisk**, b. October 3, 1947 (57). Director of Employee Health. Recurring.
- **Mrs. Evangeline Truitt**, b. December 1, 1934 (70). QGH board member, a Charleston-born former Apollo showgirl (1953), married three times. Recurring ally.
- **Imani Batts** (b. March 30, 1989), step team captain; **Cheryl Batts** (b. June 1, 1964), NYPD Transit Bureau officer.
- **Dr. Abraham Lowery**, b. January 9, 1947 (58), attending general surgeon. **Officer Delroy Mathis**, b. 1967, NYPD 108th Precinct. **Dana Whitlock** (NY1) makes her media debut.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Air France Flight 358 overran the runway at Toronto Pearson on August 2, 2005; all 309 aboard survived, evacuated within about 90 seconds.
- Syphilis: rash on the palms and soles in the secondary stage; RPR plus a confirmatory treponemal test; benzathine penicillin G 2.4 million units IM; Jarisch-Herxheimer reaction; NYC DOH partner notification. Rising NYC rates in the early 2000s are accurate.
- HCM sudden cardiac arrest; bystander CPR and AED; post-arrest therapeutic hypothermia (adopted around 2002-2005); ICD placement; the 2005-era guidelines restricting competitive sports for HCM (Bethesda 36). All accurate.
- Music: 'We Belong Together' (2005), 'Lose Control' (2005), 'Candy Shop' (2005) and 'Before I Let Go' (1981) are all period-accurate. The Electric Slide is period-accurate; no 2007-or-later line dances are used.